

CATHERINE JASON

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student (3.9 GPA, AAS in Cybersecurity) working toward a Tier 1 SOC Analyst role. Hold CompTIA Security+ and BCR Cyber's SOCOA I certification. Currently support technology and security operations for a 42-school district, managing Active Directory accounts, administering endpoints through Intune and MECM, and reviewing logs and Defender alerts in a NIST/DoIT-aligned environment. Also run an independent IT and cybersecurity practice for small business and individual clients, including malware detection and remediation, and previously led a large-scale device deployment rollout across the district.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), issued August 2026
- SOC Operations Analyst I (SOCOA I), BCR Cyber, issued October 2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & SIEM: Splunk log analysis and alert triage, log correlation, IOC review, incident response fundamentals

Network Security: TCP/IP, VLANs, NAT, DHCP, Cisco Catalyst switching (2950, 2960 Plus, 3560G), Cisco 4331 ISR routing, Wireshark traffic analysis and baselining

Intrusion Detection & Vulnerability Tools: SNORT, Nessus, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Hashcat, Aircrack-ng

Digital Forensics: FTK Imager, OSForensics, E3 Forensic Platform, ProDiscover, chain-of-custody documentation

Systems & Identity: Windows Server, Active Directory and Group Policy, Linux (Kali, Parrot, Ubuntu), Microsoft Intune, MECM/SCCM, BitLocker, Dell Command Update

Security Concepts: Access control and least privilege, authentication, cryptography basics, risk management (NIST/ISO frameworks)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technology Services Specialist

Aug 2026 to Present

Carroll County Public Schools, Westminster, MD

- Manage user accounts and group memberships in Active Directory, applying least-privilege access practices across the district's User Management System
- Administer endpoint devices through Microsoft Intune and MECM/SCCM, pushing compliance policies, deploying patches, and enforcing BitLocker encryption
- Review endpoint logs and Defender alerts daily to catch security issues early
- Handle remote technical support for staff using Quick Assist and other Microsoft device management tools
- Keep device inventory records accurate for asset tracking and lifecycle planning
- Work in a department aligned to NIST SP 800-53 and Maryland DoIT security standards

IT Deployment Technician (Seasonal)

Summer 2026

Carroll County Public Schools, Westminster, MD

- Deployed and imaged more than 6,000 student devices and 45 staff systems across 42 school sites for the district's one-to-one rollout, completing configuration tasks independently
- Joined devices to Active Directory and enrolled them in Intune/MECM during imaging so domain join and compliance policies applied correctly
- Pushed Windows security updates district-wide via Dell Command Update, Software Center (SCCM) for staff devices, and Company Portal (Intune) for student devices
- Verified BitLocker encryption on staff devices before handoff
- Ran and confirmed scheduled backup and restore procedures for disaster recovery readiness
- Managed end-of-life device transitions, including wiping, staging, and auditing retired hardware, tracked by site

Independent IT & Cybersecurity Support Consultant

2024 to Present

Self-employed, Sykesville, MD

- Provide on-demand IT and cybersecurity troubleshooting for small business and individual clients across Windows and macOS
- Resolve account access issues, performance problems, and suspected security events using Quick Assist, Remote Desktop, Screen Sharing, AnyDesk, and TeamViewer

- Run manual malware and persistence checks on Applications, LaunchAgents/LaunchDaemons, login items, and configuration profiles
- Identified and safely removed a suspicious unauthorized installer before execution, preventing potential Trojan activation on a client's system
- Review browser extensions and settings for redirects or tampering, then run full-system malware scans to confirm the fix held
- Talked a client through isolating a compromised Windows device by phone and resetting security settings, which resolved persistent malicious pop-ups
- Coach clients through remediation and basic endpoint hardening during live troubleshooting sessions

INTERNSHIP

Cybersecurity Intern, Cyber Ready Clinic (CRC)

Sep 2026 to Present (In Progress)

Cyber Ready Clinic, a 501(c)(3) founded by the co-founders of Tenable, Columbia, MD

- Selected for a competitive 10-week cybersecurity internship mentored by CRC's Executive Director, a former U.S. Secret Service CISO, and CEO, a former Anomali CISO
- Learning the Discover5 and Ready5 assessment methodologies, covering business risk across people, operations, finances, and IT, plus cyber capability review across identity, endpoints, email, network, and response
- Will conduct a live security assessment for a real nonprofit client and close out with a capstone identifying a capability gap and presenting fixes to a mentor

PROJECTS

Honey-AI: LLM Injection Honeypot

- Built a tool that mimics a standard AI customer service chatbot to catch and log jailbreak and prompt injection attempts
- Ran it on local LLMs through Ollama with a FastAPI backend for detection logic and a Streamlit chat interface
- Added a dashboard to track exploitation trends over time

Network Infrastructure Build

- Designed and configured a segmented lab network on physical hardware, using Cisco Catalyst switches, a 4331 ISR router, VLANs, routing, NAT, and DHCP
- Validated the configuration by capturing and baselining traffic in Wireshark against controlled test scenarios

Home SOC Lab

- Built a virtual lab (Kali Linux and Windows hosts) simulating brute-force login attempts and port scans
- Correlated authentication logs across hosts in Splunk and triaged findings to separate false positives from real events

Digital Forensics Investigation

- Imaged and examined disk artifacts, file systems, and registry data using FTK Imager, OSForensics, E3 Forensic Platform, and ProDiscover
- Documented every finding under proper chain-of-custody practices

EDUCATION

- Associate of Applied Science in Cybersecurity, Carroll Community College, GPA 3.9 (Expected Dec 2026)
- CompTIA CertMaster Learn & Labs for Security Pro+, Carroll Community College, GPA 4.0 (Dec 2025)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Phi Theta Kappa Honor Society International, Alpha Psi Psi Chapter
- Cybersecurity Association, Inc.
- Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS)